GRADUATE EDUCATION

NEW STUDENT ORIENTATION

Dr. Amanda Lathrop | Dean of Graduate Education

CAL POLY

GRADUATE EDUCATION



Dean, Graduate Education
Amanda Lathrop

Department Coordinator
Alinda Cole



Thesis Editors

Academic Advisor
Rebecca Richards



Graduate Student Advisor

Admin Analyst
Emily Hansen



GRADUATE COORDINATOR



- Engage prospective students and manage program admissions
- Support graduate students through the administrative process
- Advise graduate students (academic, conflicts)
- Link between Graduate Education and department/faculty/students

FACULTY ADVISOR

- Thesis or project advisor
  - Determine topic
  - May provide funding
- Research methods
- Coursework
- Mentor (research, professional)
- Networking



GRAD ED ACADEMIC ADVISOR

- **Guiding you through policies & procedures**

- **Here when life happens**
  - Whether you need to pause, adjust, or explore options, I'll walk you through things like leaves of absence or enrollment changes.

- **Keeping you on track**
  - Support for academic challenges, planning ahead, and making sure you know your options if things get tough.

- **Connecting you to resources**
  - From wellness to career services, I'll connect you to the right support at the right time.



GRADUATE STUDENT COMMUNITY

GRAD ED OFFICE & LOCKERS

Found in Building 52, Room D27

- Graduate Student Lounge
- Graduate Education Staff
- Free semesterly rental of a locker
  - *Check out a lock & locker at the office!*



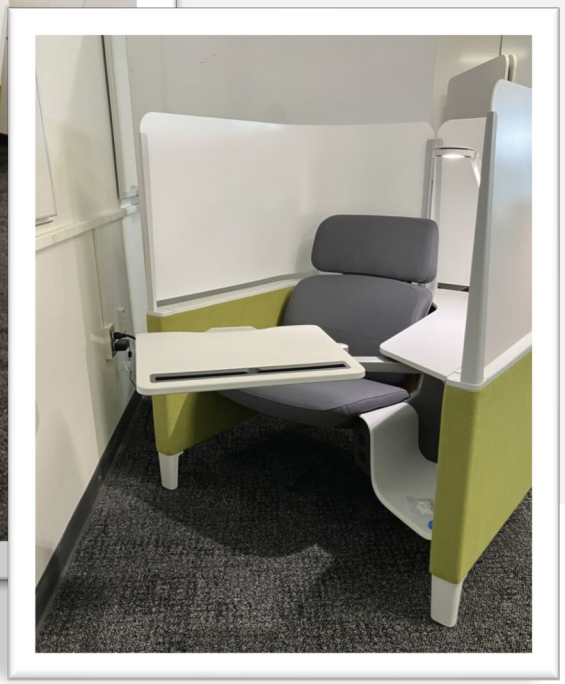


LIBRARY GRADUATE LOUNGE

- Kennedy Library 4th floor, room 401
- Access for Grad Students
- Library opening hours
- Leave the space tidy!

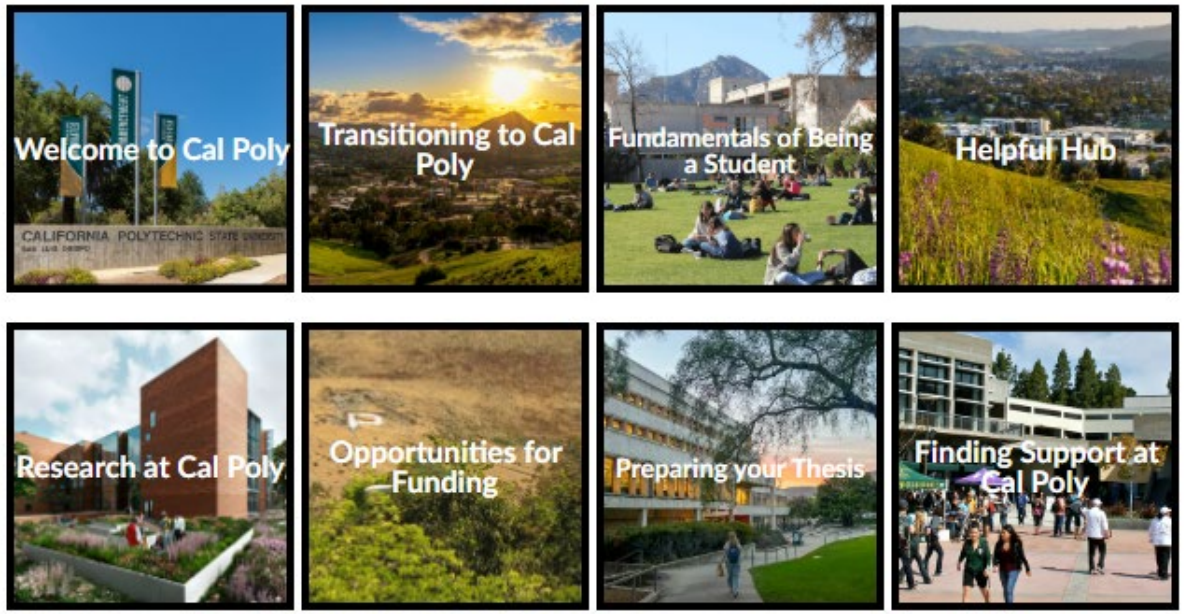






GRADUATE EDUCATION CANVAS

- **Graduate Student Materials 2026-2027**
- Expect an invitation by the end of the first week of classes
  - Monitor announcements for important due dates, financial award and job opportunities, and graduate student socials



GRADUATE STUDENT ASSOCIATION (GSA)

Meet your President: Rita Nour Rizk

What is GSA about?

- Building campus community amongst graduate students
- Hosting professional development workshops
- Organizing networking events
- Bonding activities such as bonfires, fundraising events and much more!

@CALPOLY.GSA



GSA's Group me

GRADUATE STUDENT ASSOCIATION (GSA)

GSA board application!

Open positions are:

- Vice president
- Social media and outreach team
- Secretary
- Propose your own position!

Apply now!

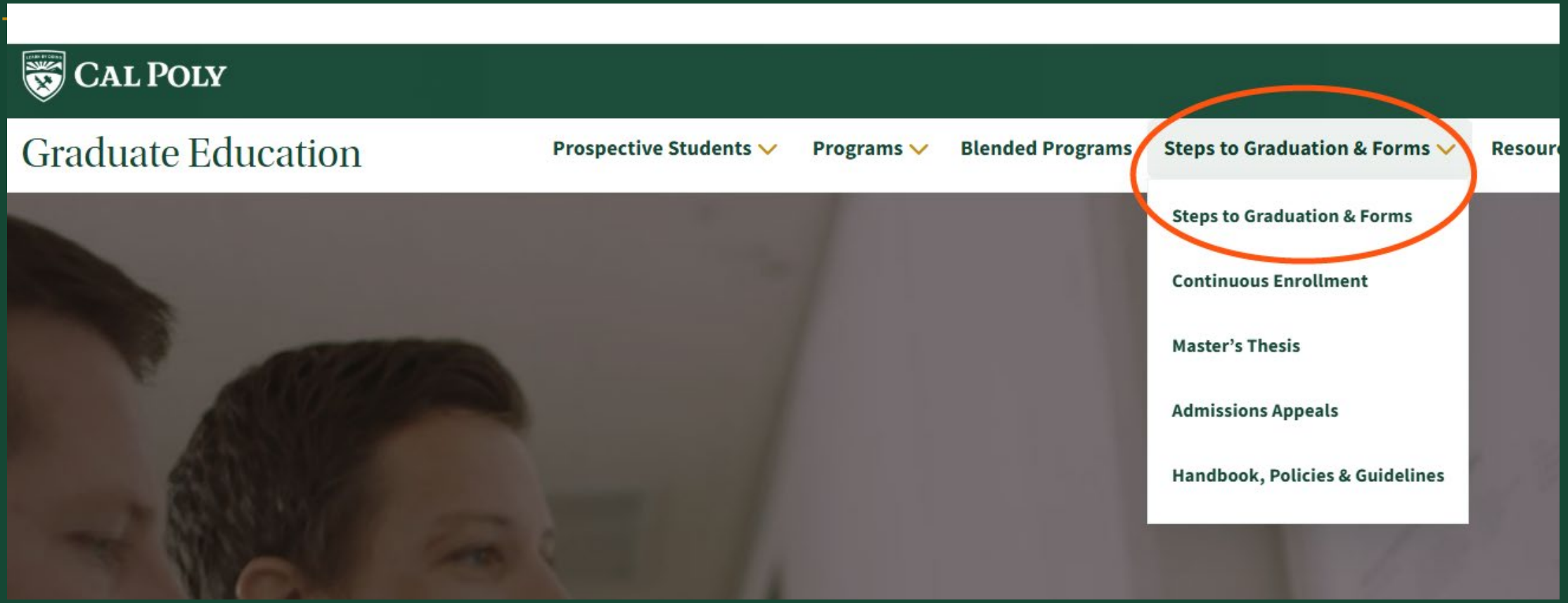
Application closes September 4th

POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

STEPS TO GRADUATION

- Communication of important academic **milestones** and **approvals**.
- Because every program and student follows a different timeline, these milestones are not tracked automatically.
  - **You are responsible for keeping the university informed as you progress.**
- We'll show you what to complete, when to reach out, and where to get help.

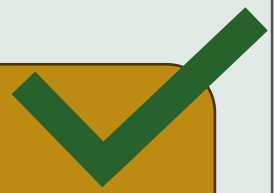
GRAD.CALPOLY.EDU



STEPS TO GRADUATION

PHASE 1

Admissions



PHASE 2

Track Your Degree Progress

Advancement to Candidacy

PHASE 3

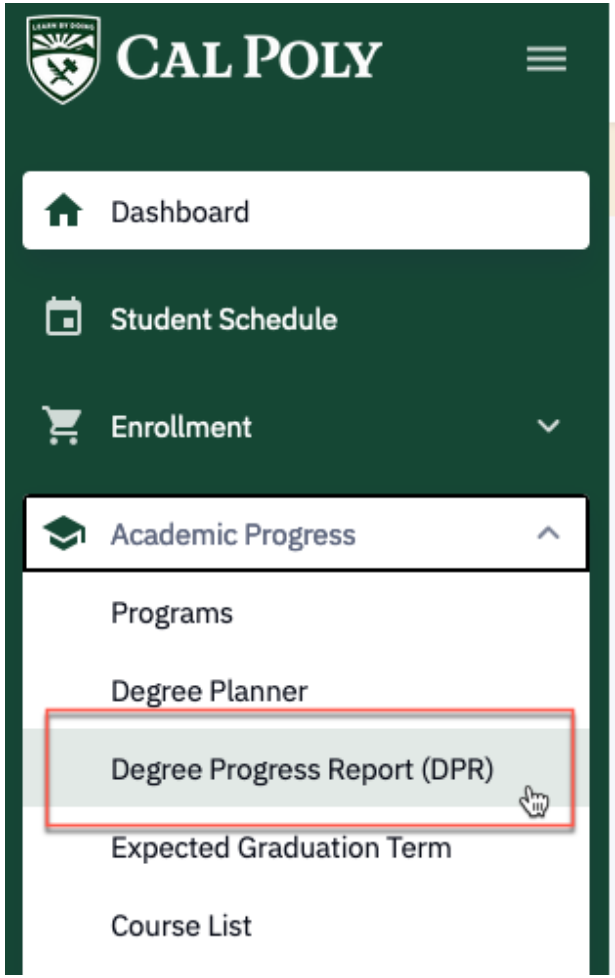
Intent to Complete Degree

Final Curriculum Plan*

Culminating Experience Approval

TRACK YOUR DEGREE PROGRESS

- **Blended students** track degree progress with your *Curriculum Plan* (submitted with your Blended Application).
- **All other students** starting Fall 2026 track their progress with their *Degree Progress Report*.



ADVANCING TO CANDIDACY (ATC)

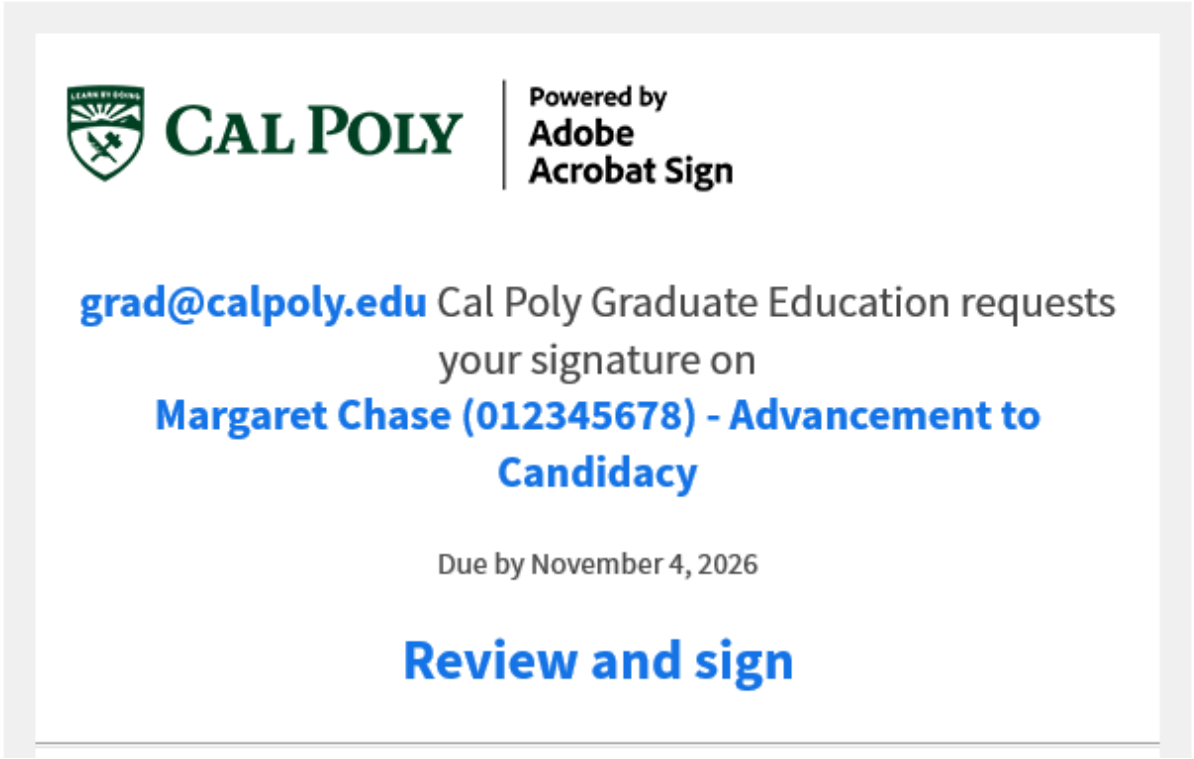


"Recognizes that the student has, so far, **sufficiently demonstrated** the ability to operate at and sustain a level of scholarly competence that is satisfactory for the **successful completion of the degree requirements**."

(Title 5, Article 7, 40510a and 41011)

ADVANCING TO CANDIDACY

- Once eligible, you'll receive your ATC form via **AdobeSign**.
- Eligibility may include completion of 6+ graduate units, a 3.0+ GPA, and approved culminating experience details.
- Requirements vary by program.
- **Review the form** and confirm your culminating experience, advisor, etc.



INTENT TO COMPLETE DEGREE

- Notifies the university of your intent to **complete your program**.
- Expected graduation term then added to your PolyProfile.

Postbaccalaureate Graduate (Active in Program)

Admitted in Winter Quarter 2026 as a First-Time Graduate
Expected graduation is Spring Semester 2027 (Applied for Graduation)

Blended Curriculum Plan

List all degree-applicable coursework below in the order completed, starting with the oldest course and ending with the most recent. Please take your time when completing this document, as accuracy is important. This is the document the Registrar's Office will use to evaluate your coursework.

Courses should be listed with the course title, course number, and units as they appeared at the time you completed the course. For example, courses taken under the quarter system should be listed with the quarter course number/title and quarter unit count. Courses taken under the semester system should be listed with the semester course number/title and semester unit count. The document will complete the necessary conversions and calculate your total units according to your catalog. It will also confirm that you have completed the required number of 500/5000-level courses.

If you completed the same course more than once, list each instance separately and place each one in the correct order based on when you completed it.

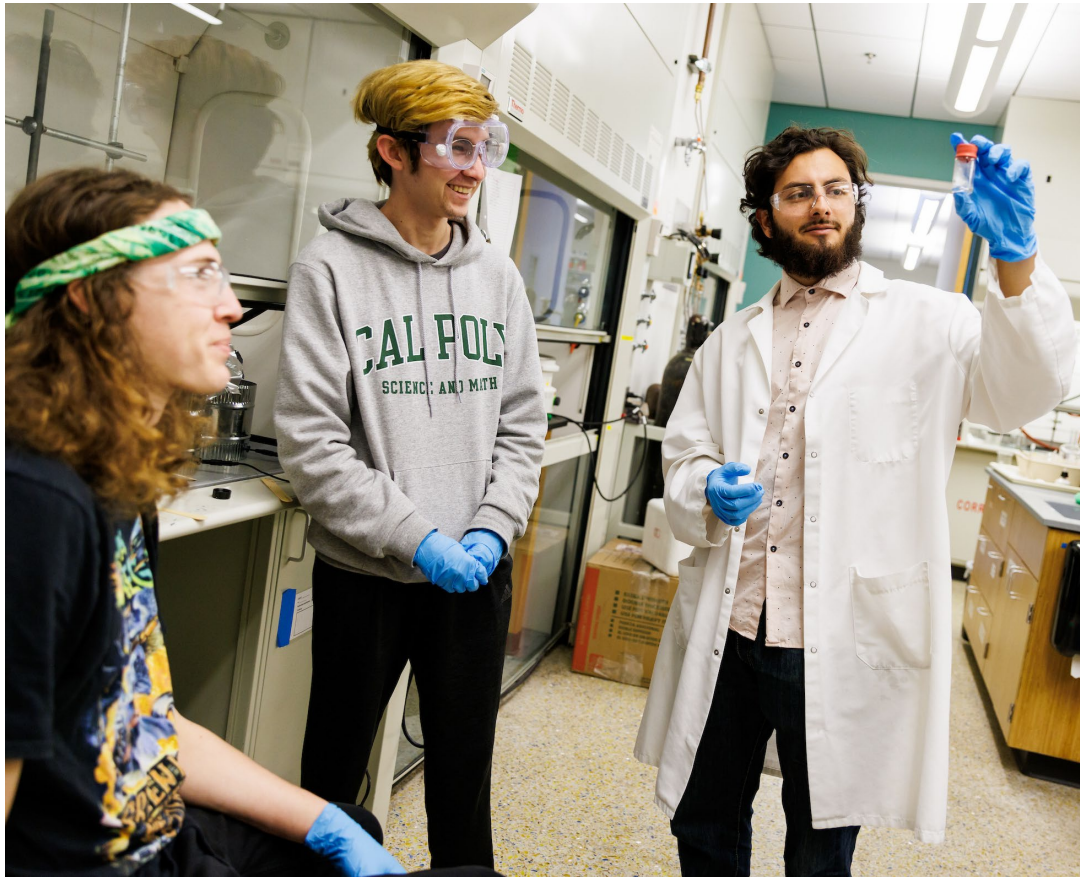
Student First & Last Name:		Current Running Total Degree Applicable Units		0.00
EMPL ID #:				
Catalog Year		Total Degree Applicable Units Needed for Master's		
Master's				
Specilization		500/5000	#VALUE!	0.00

Blended Bachelor's/Master's Degrees Only: List courses approved to double count between both degrees

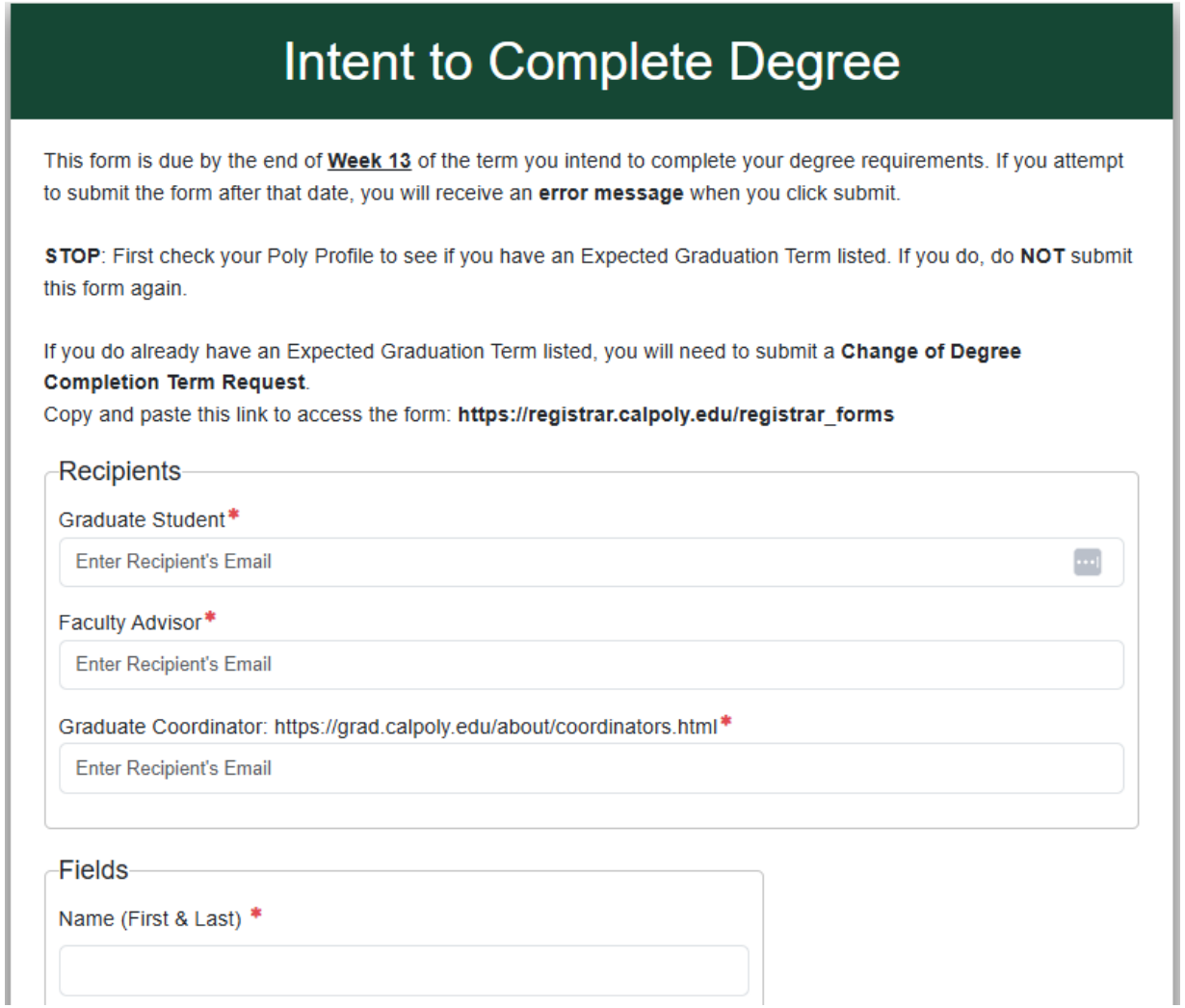
Blended students will attach a **Final Curriculum Plan** listing the courses that apply toward their degree.

CULMINATING EXPERIENCE

- Communicates to the university your successful completion of your **culminating experience**.
- Approved by your advisor, committee (if applicable), Graduate Coordinator, and Graduate Education.



HOW TO SUBMIT...



Intent to Complete Degree

This form is due by the end of **Week 13** of the term you intend to complete your degree requirements. If you attempt to submit the form after that date, you will receive an **error message** when you click submit.

STOP: First check your Poly Profile to see if you have an Expected Graduation Term listed. If you do, do **NOT** submit this form again.

If you do already have an Expected Graduation Term listed, you will need to submit a **Change of Degree Completion Term Request**.
Copy and paste this link to access the form: **https://registrar.calpoly.edu/registrar_forms**

Recipients

Graduate Student *
Enter Recipient's Email

Faculty Advisor *
Enter Recipient's Email

Graduate Coordinator: https://grad.calpoly.edu/about/coordinators.html *
Enter Recipient's Email

Fields

Name (First & Last) *

- Enter the emails. Ensure they are listed correctly.
- You are then emailed a link to the AdobeForm.
  - Didn't receive it? Check your spam folder.
- Need to cancel a form?
  - Click Options → Decline to Sign or email grad@calpoly.edu
  - Important: Duplicate forms may cause issues or delays in processing.

WHERE IS THE DOCUMENT?

- You will receive an email from AdobeSign when your form has been signed by all parties
- When your form is complete save a copy
- *Questions?* Reach out to your Graduate Coordinator or grad@calpoly.edu (name and EMPL ID)



THESIS SUBMISSION

- Your thesis represents significant research and writing — **don't forget formatting requirements.**
- Submit by the **thesis submission deadline**.
- Thesis editors will review and send required edits.
- **Respond quickly** so your thesis can be posted by the publication deadline.
- Use the **Thesis Guidelines, Handbook, and Template** on the Graduate Education website.

- Submission deadline: November 20th
- Publication deadline: December 18th

POLICY REMINDERS

CONTINUOUS ENROLLMENT

- Enrolled in regular courses
- Leave of Absence, if needed
- Can maintain via GS S5597
- **Must be enrolled in the term the student graduates**

7-YEAR RULE

- Exceptional cases may extend
- Submit the request prior to 7-year mark
- Must specify end date

GRADE REQUIREMENTS

- GPA 3.0
- Nothing lower than a C- can count toward the degree
- No “grade-forgiveness” policy for graduates

EMAILS FROM GRADUATE EDUCATION

Grad@CalPoly.edu

*****MUST READ*****

Important information on degree deadlines

Issues with your paperwork

PLEASE RESPOND WITHIN 24 HRS

Canvas

Events

Financial opportunities

Participation requests

Employment opportunities

SEMESTER CONVERSION

We are doing it!

Blended Bachelor's/Master's Students:

- Double check your enrollment
  - Ensure you aren't enrolled in class you already have credit for
- If changing undergrad catalog meet with undergrad advisor if you haven't yet



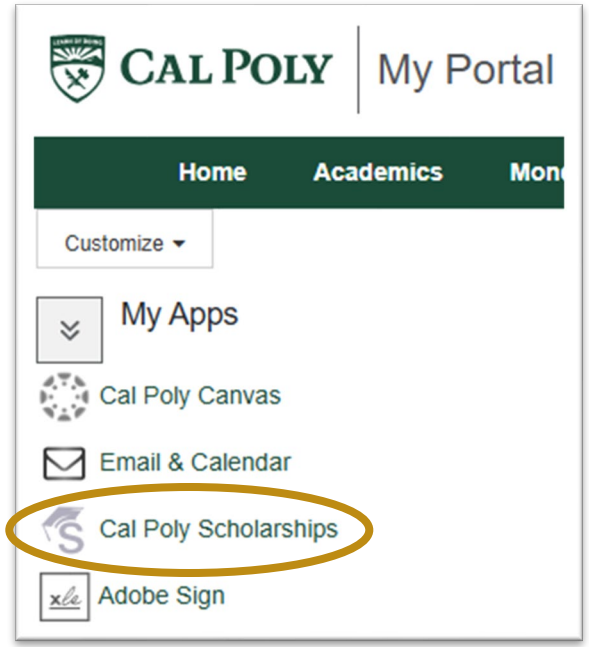
FINANCIAL OPPORTUNITIES

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Free Application for Federal Student Aid (FAFSA)

Students returning next year should complete this no later than **March 2**

Cal Poly Scholarships



Returning students complete around March each year

FINANCIAL OPPORTUNITIES

CSU Predoc & CDIP

California Predoctoral Program

- Interested in a Doctoral degree?
- Need support to explore this interest?

Chancellor's Doctoral Incentive Program

- Want to teach at a CSU?
- Will you be in a Doctoral program?

Co-Coordinator – Anna Cahn (FSN)

Conference, Research, & More

- **Conference Award**
  - Up to $500 to present at a conference
- **Research Award**
  - Research costs up to $500
- **Connect early with faculty & staff on research and more.**
  - They may be aware of other opportunities.

CSU CAREER READINESS TRAINING

CSU Career Readiness Training for Graduate Students

- 8 self-paced online modules
- Earn a digital badge for each module
- Complete all 8 to earn a CSU Career Readiness micro-credential



OTHER TIPS

- Create an email signature for your Cal Poly account and add your name and Empl ID to the signature.
- Download and save any documents you submit for future reference.
- Check your student portal regularly for holds, messages, or to-do items.
- Do not stop checking your Cal Poly email until your degree is conferred.
- Attend at least one department or Graduate Education event each term—it's a great way to meet faculty and other students.
- Find something to do outside of classes that brings you joy. Our Campus Support Service partners may have some recommendations.

QUESTIONS?

WERE YOU PAYING ATTENTION?

- How does a student maintain continuous enrollment?
- What GPA must I maintain?
- What is a passing grade?
- What should I do when I get an email from Grad@calpoly.edu?
- What are the steps to graduation?
- You have a Graduate Education question, your friend tells you one thing, your advisor says another, and a website tells you something different. How do you get an accurate answer?

Please scan the code to check in

CAMPUS SUPPORT SERVICES

THANK YOU!

- Join us for tacos outside
- Optional campus tour starts at 12.30 PM
  - Meet by the flag
  - Didn’t register but want to join? Come find us!

Last chance: scan the code to check-in

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